Indian Ocean Rim Business Forum (IORBF), and the Indian Ocean Rim Academic Group (IORAG). The Association holds a Council of Ministers meeting once every two years. The working groups have business and academic representatives to ensure that different points of view and interests are fully reflected in IOR-ARC's work programme.

The IOR-ARC *Action Plan* is a vision enumerated in Article 3.2 of IOR-ARC Charter. IOR-ARC aims to formulate and implement projects for economic co-operation relating to trade facilitation, promotion and liberalisation; promotion of foreign investment, scientific and technological exchanges, and tourism, movement of natural persons and service providers on a non-discriminatory basis; and development of infrastructure and human resources, as laid down in the Work Programme of the Association. (Art. 3.2 of IOR-ARC Charter)

India is interested in reaching out to the Indian Ocean Rim countries not only for economic engagements but also to counter the menace of piracy. India also calls for people-to-people contact and more joint projects between India and the Rim countries. The Government of India is offering scholarships to meritorious students from Malaysia, for Postgraduate courses only, for the academic year 2011–2012 under the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation (IOR-ARC) Scholarship scheme. The Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) administers the scholarship programme. The first Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation (IOR-ARC) Film Festival was hosted by New Delhi on 22 February 2008. India had offered to host this Festival at the 7th Council of Ministers Meeting of IOR-ARC held in March 2007.

The IOR-ARC must engage more in maritime cooperation which have got a very little attention and only been limited to developing, upgrading and management of ports. The Indian Ocean forms an important channel for drugs and arms. Afghanistan, Iran and Pakistan, form the 'Golden Crescent' and two member countries, viz, Iran and Pakistan are part of it. Again Myanmar and Thailand are part of the 'Golden Triangle' encompassing Myanmar, Vietnam, Laos and Thailand. Both 'Golden Crescent' and Golden Triangle' are infamous for illegal drug production. Therefore, there arises a prime